Official Pickleball Rules and Governance (2012)

I. Governance and Mission

As the sport prepares for a global explosion, the 2012 rulebook focuses on high-speed play and television-friendly consistency. The International Federation begins coordinating closely with the USAPA.

II. Equipment & Court Standards

Paddle 'Quiet Zone' requirements are introduced in response to community noise complaints. Technology now allows for high-friction surfaces, leading to the first 'Surface Roughness' tests.

III. Service Mechanics and Evolution

Experiments with the 'Drop Serve' begin in recreational play, though it remains non-standard for high-level tournaments. The volley serve remains the dominant and preferred competitive method.

IV. Gameplay Dynamics

Side-out scoring remains the bedrock, but the rulebook now includes an appendix for 'Rally Scoring' trials in junior leagues to speed up match times.

V. Conduct and Professionalism

The 'Line Call Integrity' rule is strengthened. Deliberately poor line calls in sanctioned play can now lead to immediate point forfeiture and tournament disqualification.